



### Xperia Ion in India

Sony has officially announced the launch of its Xperia Ion in India, which is priced at ₹36,999



### Google Play gift cards

Google has announced Google Play gift cards using which you can purchase apps or multimedia on Google Play

# Gadgets Galore

The month of August saw a lot of new additions to the Indian personal technology market, with the host of new budget ICS tablets stealing most of the attention, along with some expensive tablet offerings. Some global announcements were also noteworthy, including new cameras from major manufacturers

## Tablets Ahead

So far, Microsoft has not revealed even the tentative pricing of its two upcoming tablets, Surface for Windows 8 Pro and Windows RT, or those of its OEM partners' offerings. Recently however, Lenovo's David Schmook, in an interview with news agency Bloomberg, let slip the expected price range



Funtab Fit Tablet 522

of the two versions of Windows 8 tablets, with the x86-based Pro editions expected to be between \$600 and \$700, and the ARM-based RT editions expected to be \$200 to \$300 less, putting them between \$300 and \$500.

In the meanwhile, back in India, the 10.1-inch Funbook Pro tablet has been launched by Micromax, an Android 4.0 ICS-based offering priced at ₹9,999, featuring a 1.2 GHz processor and 1 GB of RAM. Other specs of the Funbook Pro include a VGA front facing camera, and 8 GB built-in storage.

Karbons Mobiles has also launched a 7-inch budget ICS tablet, called the Smart Tab 1, which is scheduled to get a Jelly Bean update soon. Strangely, Karbons Mobiles further muddied waters, by announcing an identical Smart Tab 2 (also



Karbons Smart Tab 2

priced at ₹6,990), with the only difference being it will ship with Jelly Bean out of the box. The tablets are powered by a 1.2 GHz Ingenix JZ4770 SoC.

Zync has launched another 7-inch budget tablet as well, except this runs Gingerbread. Called the Z909 Plus, which will retail for just ₹3,699, and feature a 1 GHz processor and 256 MB of RAM. ICE X Electronics launched an ICS-based tablet as well, called the ICE Xtreme tablet, which was priced at ₹6,999, and features a 7-inch



Micromax Funbook Pro-522

display, a 1 GHz processor, and 1 GB of DDR3 RAM.

Joining the budget ICS bandwagon, was the Funtab Fit, which was launched at ₹5,999, and features a 7-inch display, a 1 GHz processor and 512 MB of RAM. Pantel has once again teamed up with BSNL, to release an ICS-based T-Pad IS701C tablet at ₹4,999. It's a 7-inch

tablet with a 1 GHz processor, and 512 MB of RAM.

Swipe Telecom has also launched three budget ICS tablets in India – these are the Swipe 3D Life, Swipe Halo TabX74S and Swipe Float TabX78, priced at ₹5,999, ₹6,999 and ₹8,999 respectively. They all feature 7-inch displays, with processors clocked between 1.2



BSNL Panel Tpad

GHz and 1.5 GHz, coupled with 512 MB of RAM.

Globally, the Samsung Galaxy Note 10.1 has gone on sale in the US and UK. Interestingly, the Korean giant has also released the Galaxy Note 10.1 in India. It will set you back by a whopping ₹39,990.

Under the hood, the ICS-based Galaxy Note 10.1 called the Samsung Galaxy Note 800 boasts of some pretty impressive specifications. The device has an Exynos 4412 Quad 1.4



ICE Xtreme



Samsung Galaxy Tab 2

GHz quad-core processor, Mali-400MP graphics and a whopping 2 GB of RAM.

Meanwhile, new leaked images of Sony Xperia Tablet have been doing the rounds of the internet, showcasing a slimmer design. Also known as the Tablet SGPT1211, the ICS-based tablet is said to run on the quad-core Tegra 3 processor, and feature a 9.4-inch display.

The Jelly Bean platform lead device, the Google Nexus



Sony Xperia Tablet

7 tablet, has been eagerly awaited in India ever since it was revealed at Google IO 2012, with Indians looking forward to a cheap tablet with the fastest upgrade paths. However, no official availability was disclosed by the search giant. The 7-inch device however, has been made available in the country via Indiatimes and other online retailers, with the 8GB model starting at ₹16,952. After con-